

Impact High · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk Medium

THE MOVE

State the conclusion -> Give one reason -> Offer context if asked

START HERE

Before speaking or writing, ask: 'What is the one thing I want them to take away?' Say that first.

SAY THIS

BLUF Openers	<i>"Bottom line: I recommend..."</i>
Context Offers	<i>"I can give you the background if you need it."</i>
Everyday BLUF	<i>"Short answer: yes."</i>
Written BLUF	<i>"Decision needed: X or Y, by Friday."</i>
On-the-Spot BLUF	<i>"My answer is yes — with one condition I want to flag."</i>

AVOID

- When delivering bad news that requires emotional preparation before the conclusion.
- In high-stakes persuasion where building context first changes how the audience receives your point.
- When the audience genuinely needs background to evaluate the bottom line — give the bottom line, then immediately offer the context.

REMEMBER

Write the last sentence first.